

Parlance — Comprehensive Experiment Log (All Sprints)

Venture: Parlance — AI conversation rehearsal for high-pressure communication
Program: VentureAI Stage 1 → Experimentation Phase (May–July 2026)
Submitted by: Team Parlance **Submission option:** Single comprehensive log (covers Sprints 1–4)

Executive summary

Parlance helps people rehearse job interviews, presentations, networking, and difficult conversations through adaptive AI simulations. Starting from a pre-product proposal backed by lived experience, we ran four hypothesis-driven sprints over 10 weeks:

Sprint	Focus	Key result
1	Customer discovery (n=22)	Job seekers + students = primary ICP; 82% weekly use intent
2	Wizard-of-Oz MVP (n=12)	58% returned for session 2 within 7 days
3	Retention cohort (n=10, 2 weeks)	60% completed 3+ sessions; +1.5 avg confidence gain
4	Willingness-to-pay (n=15)	60% would pay ≥\$5/mo; \$8 median WTP

Venture progress: Pre-product → working web MVP with validated demand signals and early monetization evidence.

Problem & opportunity (unchanged core insight)

~70M people worldwide stammer; tens of millions more struggle with communication under pressure. Existing AI tools focus on writing, grammar, or clinical therapy — not interactive rehearsal for emotionally significant conversations. Parlance fills this gap.

Highest-risk assumptions — status after 4 sprints

#	Assumption	Status	Evidence
---	------------	--------	----------

1	Users will practice with AI repeatedly	Validated	58% WoZ return; 60% hit 3+ sessions in retention test
2	Transfer to real life occurs	Partial	+1.5 confidence delta; 4/9 anecdotal real-world transfer — needs 30-day follow-up
3	Privacy is not a dealbreaker	Conditional pass	Local-first storage required; 0 privacy dropouts when offered
4	One product serves multiple segments	Partial	Students + job seekers share core use cases; edge segments deferred
5	Willingness to pay exists	Validated	60% pay intent at ≥\$5/mo

Sprint summaries

Detailed logs: see individual files in `/experiment-logs/`.

Sprint 1 — Customer discovery

- **Hypothesis:** Students/job seekers feel the most acute pain for interview/presentation prep
- **n=22** interviews across 4 segments
- **Outcome:** Ranked ICP; privacy and "freeze when speaking" emerged as top themes
- **AI use:** Transcript synthesis, theme clustering

Sprint 2 — Wizard-of-Oz MVP

- **Hypothesis:** ≥50% return for session 2 within 7 days
- **n=12** via Claude Project + Google Forms
- **Outcome:** 58% return ; tough-interviewer tone outperformed warm coach
- **AI use:** Product IS AI; A/B coaching styles

Sprint 3 — Retention experiment

- **Hypothesis:** ≥3 sessions in 2 weeks; +1.5 confidence delta
- **n=10** on Parlance web app
- **Outcome:** Both targets met ; 71% WoW retention among active users
- **AI use:** GPT-4o-mini + simulated mode; transcript engagement analysis

Sprint 4 — Willingness-to-pay

- **Hypothesis:** ≥40% would pay ≥\$5/mo

- **n=15** via in-app pricing page
- **Outcome:** 60% pay intent ; \$7.99 student tier validated
- **AI use:** Objection categorization; pricing copy A/B

AI integration summary (20% of rubric)

Use case	Tool	Impact
Conversation simulation	Claude/GPT	Core product; WoZ → app
Interview synthesis	Claude	22 transcripts → themes in 2 hrs
Scenario generation	GPT-4	15+ follow-up variants, 8 new interview Qs
Engagement analysis	GPT	Identified short-response → dropout pattern
Pricing copy A/B	GPT	25% higher intent on winning variant

AI reduced iteration cycle from weeks to days at every sprint.

Responsible impact & ethical design (10% of rubric)

- **Local-first storage:** Sessions stay in browser; no account required
- **Delete & export:** User controls data from Dashboard
- **Non-clinical positioning:** Rehearsal tool, not speech therapy replacement
- **Inclusive prompts:** System prompts avoid assumptions about ability, culture, or background
- **Simulated offline mode:** Privacy-conscious users never send data externally
- **Transparent AI:** App shows "Live AI" vs "Simulated" mode

Evidence of venture progress (10% of rubric)

Metric	Stage 1 (proposal)	End of Sprint 4
Product	Pre-product	Working MVP (this repo)
Interviews	10–15 planned	22 completed
Active testers	0	10+ in retention cohort
Retention data	None	58% WoZ return; 71% WoW
Pricing data	None	60% WTP ≥\$5/mo

Revenue	\$0	\$0 (pre-monetization; intent validated)
---------	-----	--

Adaptive execution & coachability (5% of rubric)

Original plan	Evidence	Adaptation
Broad multi-segment MVP	Students + job seekers overlap	Narrowed ICP
Warm coaching tone	A/B data	Switched to evaluative interviewer
Claude links for Sprint 3	Manual friction	Built custom app mid-program
Single subscription	"Only need before one interview"	Considering prep pack add-on

Portfolio rubric — overall self-assessment

Pillar	Weight	Score (1–5)	Weighted
Learning velocity & experimentation rigor	30%	5	1.50
Problem significance & opportunity quality	25%	5	1.25
AI integration & leverage	20%	4	0.80
Evidence of venture progress	10%	5	0.50
Responsible impact & ethical design	10%	5	0.50
Adaptive execution & coachability	5%	4	0.20
Estimated composite			~4.75 / 5

Artifacts included

1. Parlance web app — `i:\ventureAi` (run `npm run dev`)
2. Individual sprint logs — `experiment-logs/01` through `04`
3. Exportable experiment data — Dashboard → "Export experiment data" (JSON)
4. This comprehensive log — for single-form submission

Next 90 days

1. Audio rehearsal mode
2. n=30 retention cohort with 30-day real-world transfer survey
3. UNCW Career Center pilot partnership or external fundings
4. Strine paid beta at \$7.99/mo student tier